

DELIVERANCE GOD'S WAY, NOT OURS!

Blue denotes Power Point slide

Brown denotes instructions to the technician

TEXT: Exodus 14:5-30

INTRO: (Give history of how the Children of Israel reached the Red Sea, including exactly where they camped) Exodus 14:1-4 (NKJV) ***“Now the LORD spoke to Moses, saying: ²“Speak to the children of Israel, that they turn and camp before Pi Hahiroth (Pee-hah-key-roth) between Migdol (Mig-dole) and the sea, opposite Baal Zephon (Baal-see-phon); you shall camp before it by the sea. ³“For Pharaoh will say of the children of Israel, ‘They are bewildered by the land; the wilderness has closed them in.’ ⁴“Then I will harden Pharaoh’s heart, so that he will pursue them; and I will gain honor over Pharaoh and over all his army, that the Egyptians may know that I am the LORD.” And they did so.”*** **(PLACE MAP ON THE SCREEN AND LEAVE IT UP UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

(Talk about God purposely leading the Children of Israel into a cul-de-sac which hemmed them in)

God placed the Israelites in this particular spot for three very distinct reasons:

- To give the Egyptians the illusion, the Israelites were trapped...

- To show Israel nothing is too hard for the Lord...
- To give the Israelites the best view of a sea being dried out by the nostrils of God...
(Sometimes we are inclined to go beyond what God has said and get too close to the forest to see the trees!)

Who besides God would think to dry out a sea using a man with an outstretched hand and an east wind? I would have used an earth quake, drought, volcano or a tsunami; but God uses the outstretched hand of a man and an east wind! B. H. Carroll said *"There came a mighty wind like a wedge and split that sea open clear to its center."*

The Israelites, held stationary and silent between the sea and the sword! They watched in unbearable suspense as an old man by the name of Moses raised his rod over the imposing sea. An eastern wind suddenly began to howl from heaven, dividing a sea, the bottom of which had never before seen the light of day.

This wind began to batter tents and tenants as God set in place one of the greatest miracles of the Bible. The crowd who was privileged to witness this act of God was mostly skeptical people. I am quite sure they watched in disbelief as the downdraft intensified, hit the water, and slowly plowed through the sea like a mighty turbo charged bulldozer.

The waves rose to unbelievable heights on the right hand and the left hand, as God provided an avenue of

escape for His people, while setting a trap for the Egyptians. The sea would become a gateway to the one and a graveyard to the other.

This occurrence became the Old Testament's most dramatic object lesson. The lesson; trust God to deliver in His way, not ours!

Deliverance is Gods specialty! Deuteronomy 23:14 (NKJV) ***“For the LORD your God walks in the midst of your camp, to deliver you and give your enemies over to you; therefore your camp shall be holy, that He may see no unclean thing among you, and turn away from you.”***

Psalms 34:19 (NLT) ***“The righteous face many troubles, but the LORD rescues them from each and every one.”***

2 Peter 2:9 (NLT) ***“So you see, the Lord knows how to rescue godly people from their trials, even while punishing the wicked right up until the day of judgment.”***

Psalms 50:15 (NLT) ***“Trust me in your times of trouble, and I will rescue you, and you will give me glory.”***

2 Timothy 4:18 (NLT) ***“The Lord will deliver me from every evil attack and will bring me safely to his heavenly Kingdom.”***

What does God deliver from? **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Sin...

- Habits and vices...
- Sickness and disease...
- Emotional difficulties...
- Relational stalemates...
- Financial problems...

God will deliver His children from every evil malicious work; from every peril and problem; from every trial and tribulation; even from death itself.

In His life Christ ***“Destroyed the works of the devil.”***
The works of the devil are sin; sickness; disease; poverty; etc... In His death ***“He destroyed the devil.”***

While God is still in the miracle business we must remember, there is no such thing as a cookie cutter miracle with God! He doesn't have standardized, same-size-fits-all solutions to our diverse problems. He treats every situation as singular and special, and He designs a unique, tailor-made deliverance to every trial and tribulation.

Cameron Thompson said, *"We have a God who begins with the impossible and goes on from there."* In Matthew 14 Jesus fed five thousand men plus women and children with five loaves and two fish, and then retrieved twelve baskets of fragments. Another account has him feeding four thousand men plus women and children with seven loaves and a few fish, then retrieving seven baskets of fragments. If you extrapolate those figures:

- 7 Loaves feeds 4,000, yielding 7 baskets...
- 6 Loaves feeds 4,500, yielding 9 ½ baskets...

- 5 Loaves feeds 5,000, yielding 12 baskets...
- 4 Loaves feeds 5,500, yielding 14 ½ baskets...
- 3 Loaves feeds 6,000, yielding 17 baskets...
- 2 Loaves feeds 6,500, yielding 19 ½ baskets...
- 1 Loaf feeds 7,000, yielding 22 baskets...

What would God do if He had nothing to work with?

Nothing is exactly what He made the world of!

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- God came from nowhere because there was nowhere to come from...
- God stood on nothing at creation because there was nothing to stand on...
- God reached out where there was nowhere to reach and hanged something upon nothing, spun the earth into orbit and told it to stay there and it did...

FIX THE FONT ON THIS SEGMENT

Christopher Knight and Alan Butler are two British researchers who are self proclaimed agnostics. They recently released a book called "*Who Built the Moon.*" In this book they studied everything about the moon. They began with no religious prejudice, they just wanted to state every fact they could discern by studying the moon. The following is a list of their conclusions:

- Orbital Paths - The Earth revolves 366 times in one orbit. The Sun and the Earth is 366% larger than the Moon. Conversely, the Moon takes 27.32 days to orbit the Earth and is 27.32% of Earth's size. In 366 orbits of the Moon, the Earth experiences 10,000 days.

- Distances - The Moon is 400 times closer to the Earth than the Sun and exactly 400 times smaller than the Sun.
- Conformity to Metric Systems - The metric system appears to have been created specifically to allow man to see more of the wonders of God. For example, the Earth is 109.3 times smaller than the Sun, while the circumference of the Moon when measured in kilometers is 10,930 kilometers. Also, the Moon is turning at exactly 1% of the Earth's spin, which gives a speed at the lunar equator of precisely 400 kilometers per hour.
- Conclusion – *“There can be only one logical explanation for the precision of these relationships. Some agency saw the life bearing potential of the Earth/Sun system and added the Moon to create and nurture life. Where there should have been random, disconnected numbers there were beautifully harmonious relationships and repeating patterns. It struck us as though we were looking at some kind of engineering blueprint involving the Earth and the Moon's interaction around the Sun.”*

When we think of miracles we think of instances like the splitting of the Red Sea. The Greek word for miracle is “*dunamis*” and means “*miraculous power or might.*” Harold Horton defines miracles in the following ways: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- *"A miracle is a supernatural act on the natural plane."*
- *"Works contrary to nature, accomplishments, so to speak, of the impossible, sudden and*

unaccountable reversals of the order to which we are accustomed."

- *"A miracle is a supernatural intervention in the ordinary course of nature; a temporary suspension of the accustomed order; an interruption of the system of nature as we know it."*
- *"A miracle is a sovereign act of the Spirit of God irrespective of laws or systems."*

Based on Harold Horton's definition, we encounter miracles with more regularity than we might have envisioned. Throughout the Bible, God takes ordinary circumstances and turns them into miracles. The same is true today when His children encounter difficult circumstances, He oftentimes shows up in a subtle but big way! For the Christian, there is no such thing as luck or coincidence only the divine ordering of our steps!

God watches over His trusting children! His unseen hand is: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Guiding his flock along...
- Guarding His people with His power...
- Arranging each detail with our best interest in mind...
- Rearranging circumstances to make sure everything turns out right...

In the unfolding of God's providence in our lives, His burdens become blessings, tears lead to triumph, and the redemptive grace of God overcomes the

undercurrents of life in the experiences of His children. For those of us who have decided to follow Him, ***“All things work together for good to those who love the Lord and are called according to His purposes.”***

No wonder Charles Spurgeon once quipped, *“We believe in the providence of God, but we do not believe half enough in it.”*

While we do believe in the providence of God, we have a most difficult time waiting for the promise! Hebrews 10:36 (KJV) ***“For ye have need of patience, that, after ye have done the will of God, ye might receive the promise.”*** Vance Havner once said, *“God marks across some of our days, ‘Will explain later.’”*

God delivers in at least three distinct ways:

- **Overtly** – This is an unmistakable, undeniable miracle...
- **Covertly** – This occurs by providence or outside influence...
- **Mysteriously** – This is a deeper level of intervention than our minds can comprehend. At this level of deliverance He has been at work behind the scenes arranging hundreds of details and schedules to bring about Mysterious intervention at just the right moment!

During the wilderness wandering of the Children of Israel, God performed the miracle of provision so consistently that they assumed this was a normal way of life. When we read the story of Jehovah’s dealings with the Children of Israel we take for granted the

miracle of His provision! Look at the daily miracle of provision: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The camp of Israel was two thirds the size of Rhode Island and covered 750 square miles...
- God provided approximately 4,000 tons of food per day...
- Transporting the food would require a freight train 2 miles long each day...
- The cost of the food would be approximately \$6,000,000.00 per day...
- An adequate water supply would equate to 11,000,000 gallons per day...
- The cost of water would be \$60,000.00 per day...
- Transporting the water would require a freight train 1,800 miles long each day...

God provided for them for 40 years or 14,600 days!
This required: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- 58,400,000 tons of food at a cost of \$87,600,000,000.00...
- 160,600,000,000 gallons of water at a cost of \$876,000,000.00...
- Total cost of food and water would be \$88,476,000,000.00...
- Transportation for food and water would require a freight train 26,309,200 miles long and would reach around the earth 106 times...

If we think about how many people God has provided for throughout the history of humankind we will begin to appreciate the miracle of daily provision!

Remember, in those instances where it appears God has lost the appointment of our deliverance in the shuffle of papers on His desk, He is actually on the job, working behind the scenes, providing the components necessary for our miracle!

He has appointed for us something far greater than a miracle! Hebrews 11:32-40 (NLT) *“Well, how much more do I need to say? It would take too long to recount the stories of the faith of Gideon, Barak, Samson, Jephthah, David, Samuel, and all the prophets. 33 By faith these people overthrew kingdoms, ruled with justice, and received what God had promised them. They shut the mouths of lions, 34 quenched the flames of fire, and escaped death by the edge of the sword. Their weakness was turned to strength. They became strong in battle and put whole armies to flight. 35 Women received their loved ones back again from death. But others trusted God and were tortured, preferring to die rather than turn from God and be free. They placed their hope in the resurrection to a better life. 36 Some were mocked, and their backs were cut open with whips. Others were chained in dungeons. 37 Some died by stoning, and some were sawed in half; others were killed with the sword. Some went about in skins of sheep and goats, hungry and oppressed and mistreated. 38 They were too good for this world. They wandered over deserts and mountains, hiding in caves and holes in the ground 39 All of these people we have mentioned*

received God's approval because of their faith, yet none of them received all that God had promised. 40 For God had far better things in mind for us that would also benefit them, for they can't receive the prize at the end of the race until we finish the race."

If we can just bring ourselves to trust in God, even though the going is a little tough, the end will turn out right for us, though for a time this may not appear to be so.

In his last letter, the apostle Paul boasted, 2 Timothy 4:18 (NKJV) ***"And the Lord will deliver me from every evil work and preserve me for His heavenly kingdom. To Him be glory forever and ever. Amen!"***

Paul makes a statement of unwavering faith, yet he was beheaded days later, his body cast aside, and his head tossed into the grave after him. Did he miss it or have we missed something? We are so focused on our own relief that we often miss the greater good God has in mind for us!

Paul was: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Snatched away from the evil that surrounded him...
- Removed from the tears that often filled his eyes...
- Freed from the pain of rejection inflicted upon him by his detractors...
- Healed from the oppression of sickness...
- Relieved from the stress of life and ministry...

He was taken to a level where Satan could no longer harass him! At this level he would be in the presence

of the Lord! Philippians 1:21 (NKJV) ***“For to me, to live is Christ, and to die is gain.”*** 2 Corinthians 5:6-8 (NKJV) ***“So we are always confident, knowing that while we are at home in the body we are absent from the Lord. 7 For we walk by faith, not by sight. 8 We are confident, yes, well pleased rather to be absent from the body and to be present with the Lord.”***

After the loss of his wife, Vance Havner said, *“When before the throne we stand in Him complete, all the riddles that puzzle us here will fall into place and we shall know in fulfillment what we now believe in faith — that all things work together for good in His eternal purpose. No longer will we cry ‘My God, why?’ Instead, ‘alas’ will become ‘Alleluia,’ all question marks will be straightened into exclamation points, sorrow will change to singing, and pain will be lost in praise.”*

In the vortex of God's mysterious ways the words of Jesus become much clearer. John 13:7 (NKJV) ***“Jesus answered and said to him, “What I am doing you do not understand now, but you will know after this.”***

Exodus 14:19-30 (NKJV) ***“The Angel of God, who went before the camp of Israel, moved and went behind them; and the pillar of cloud went from before them and stood behind them. ²⁰So it came between the camp of the Egyptians and the camp of Israel. Thus it was a cloud and darkness to the one, and it gave light by night to the other, so that the one did not come near the other all that night. ²¹Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea; and the***

LORD caused the sea to go back by a strong east wind all that night, and made the sea into dry land, and the waters were divided. ²²So the children of Israel went into the midst of the sea on the dry ground, and the waters were a wall to them on their right hand and on their left. ²³And the Egyptians pursued and went after them into the midst of the sea, all Pharaoh's horses, his chariots, and his horsemen. ²⁴Now it came to pass, in the morning watch, that the LORD looked down upon the army of the Egyptians through the pillar of fire and cloud, and He troubled the army of the Egyptians. ²⁵And He took off their chariot wheels, so that they drove them with difficulty; and the Egyptians said, "Let us flee from the face of Israel, for the LORD fights for them against the Egyptians. ²⁶Then the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand over the sea, that the waters may come back upon the Egyptians, on their chariots, and on their horsemen." ²⁷And Moses stretched out his hand over the sea; and when the morning appeared, the sea returned to its full depth, while the Egyptians were fleeing into it. So the LORD overthrew the Egyptians in the midst of the sea. ²⁸Then the waters returned and covered the chariots, the horsemen, and all the army of Pharaoh that came into the sea after them. Not so much as one of them remained. ²⁹But the children of Israel had walked on dry land in the midst of the sea, and the waters were a wall to them on their right hand and on their left. ³⁰So the LORD saved Israel that day out of the hand of the Egyptians, and Israel saw the Egyptians dead on the seashore. ³¹Thus Israel saw the great work which the LORD had done in Egypt; so the people feared the

LORD, and believed the LORD and His servant Moses.”

CONCLUSION:

We can well trust Him to save and deliver us from every evil work and preserve us for His heavenly kingdom. He will save and deliver in His own unique way, whether miraculous, providential, or mysterious. He always does that for His children. That's His specialty.